

Power Tips for Keyboards

The keyboard is an integral part of your computer, so care must be exercised when using it. Here are some tips for basic keyboard care, as well as some common problems and possible solutions.

Dirty Keyboard

Keyboards should be cleaned regularly with a cleaning solution and a cloth or tissue. Ensure that the computer is not powered up while cleaning the keyboard. You could also use a vacuum cleaner to suck or blow air into the keyboard to clean it.

Accidental liquid spillage

If you spill any liquid on the keyboard, turn it upside down immediately. Drain all the water out, shaking it if necessary. If you've spilled water into the keyboard, let it dry before you attempt to use it. Don't plug a wet keyboard into your PC as you may end up damaging the electrical circuitry. If the keyboard still doesn't work, you may have to replace it.

'Keyboard Not Found' error

This generally happens if your keyboard is not plugged into the computer properly. Unplug it, plug it back in and the problem should go away.

Wrong installation

Many mice and keyboards today use a PS/2 connector. If you plugged your keyboard into the mouse port (or vice versa), shut down the computer and plug the keyboard into the keyboard port. The keyboard port is usually marked with a 'key-board' symbol or is colour-coded to help you identify it.

PC does not take input from keyboard

Check if the keyboard is connected to the computer. Ensure that it's plugged into the keyboard port and not the mouse port. If the keyboard was unplugged, plug it back in and reboot the computer. If the keyboard still doesn't work on boot-up, power down the computer and borrow a working keyboard for troubleshooting. Plug the new keyboard in and boot up the computer. If the new keyboard works, the old keyboard is faulty and needs to be replaced. If the good keyboard doesn't work, check your BIOS to make sure it recognises the keyboard. It should say "installed". If the BIOS recognises the keyboard, the keyboard port may be faulty.



Stuck keys

If a key does not work, or is stuck in the down position, you may try to remove it with a pointed tool, such as a pin. Once you've pulled out the stuck key, you can try to stretch the spring to reanimate its action.

Some keys don't work

Check to see if there are any obstructions to the keys. If other keys work, your keyboard is faulty and needs to be replaced.

Don'ts:

- ✗ Do not use alcohol, solvent or anything that could remove the lettering on the keys or melt the plastic.
- ✗ Avoid spilling anything on the keyboard as the liquid may seep inside and make certain keys—or even the whole keyboard—non-functional.

Mouse Maintenance

If your mouse seems sluggish or extremely difficult to move, then it's time to clean it.

- First turn off the PC. Once it's powered down, unplug the mouse.
- Turn the mouse over. You would see a 'locking ring' that holds the mouse ball in place. This should have arrows indicating the proper direction to turn the ring to unlock it. You may have to press gently while you turn the ring.
- Once you unlock the ring with a twist, the mouse ball can be taken out.
- Moisten a tissue with cologne or any mild cleaning solution, then hold the mouse ball and clean it with a gentle rubbing motion. If the tissue gets dirty, use another one.

You will notice rollers inside the mouse. After you have cleaned it just wipe it with the cleaning solution with the help of the cotton swabs. It will be obvious when the rollers are clean. Now all you have to do is give the mouse a few minutes to dry completely.

Lastly, put the mouse back together. Once you are sure it is dry, plug it back in and turn the PC on.

Don'ts:

- ✗ Never use your nails or any other sharp device to clean the inside of the mouse, as it may damage the internal components.